Alder Quay Financial Services Ltd

Leave and Absence Policy

FICTIONAL TRAINING / TEST DOCUMENT - NOT LEGAL ADVICE

Alder Quay Financial Services Ltd is invented. All staff, systems, limits, approvals and company arrangements in this pack are synthetic. No real authorisation, regulatory registration, employment entitlement or product is represented. Use only to test document retrieval and grounded answers.

Document Id: AQ-HR-001

Version: 2.1

Effective Date: 2026-10-01

Review Date: 2027-10-01

Status: Current - synthetic

Classification: Internal - synthetic test data

Owner: People Operations

Approver: Fictional Board Policy Committee

Related documents: AQ-HR-002, AQ-HR-004, AQ-HR-005

Contents and citation guide

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Cite document ID, version and section number. All versions in this pack are current as of the shared effective date. Change notes refer to fictional history; superseded documents are not supplied.

1. Purpose and eligibility

Applies to UK employees based in England working a standard 37.5-hour, five-day week. Contractors follow their engagement terms

All allowances below are fictional company arrangements; People Operations must check applicable statutory entitlements and individual contracts before a real-world decision. A contract or legal entitlement providing greater protection takes precedence.

2. Annual leave and booking

The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. Full-time employees receive 27 days annual leave plus bank holidays observed in England and Wales. Part-time employees receive a pro-rated combined allowance, with public holidays falling on scheduled working days deducted from that allowance

Joiners and leavers accrue annual leave proportionately by calendar days employed; People Operations rounds the final allowance up to the nearest half-day. Request leave in PeopleHub at least 10 working days ahead for up to five consecutive days, and 20 working days ahead for longer requests. Managers respond within five working days. Approval depends on minimum cover, existing bookings and operational deadlines, not seniority.

3. Carry-forward and exceptions

Up to five unused annual leave days may be carried into the next leave year with manager approval recorded by 15 December. Ordinary carried days must be used by 31 March. This cap and expiry do not override protected carry-forward connected with sickness, family leave or other legal rights; People Operations assesses those cases separately

More than five ordinary days requires Head of People approval and a documented reason. Employees cannot exchange ordinary leave for cash except where due on termination. An approved booking may only be changed by mutual agreement or after People Operations reviews any applicable notice obligations and reasonable unrecoverable costs.

4. Sickness and support

Tell the line manager before the normal start time, or as soon as reasonably possible in an emergency. Log absence in PeopleHub within one working day where able. Self-certify the first seven calendar days; for longer absence provide appropriate medical evidence after People Operations confirms current requirements

Company sick pay is up to 20 scheduled working days at full basic pay in a rolling 12-month period after probation, inclusive of any statutory sick pay due. Eligibility, statutory payments and reasonable adjustments require individual review. Three absence episodes in six months prompt a supportive review, not automatic disciplinary action. Managers must not request diagnoses in team channels.

5. Family, emergency and other leave

Primary carers with 12 months service receive a fictional enhancement of 16 weeks at full basic pay, inclusive of applicable statutory pay, followed by statutory payments where eligible. This enhancement does not define the duration or availability of statutory family leave. Secondary carers receive two weeks at full basic pay inclusive of applicable statutory pay

People Operations checks eligibility, notices and statutory options case by case. Emergency dependant leave provides up to two paid working days per event, with further reasonable time assessed individually. Bereavement leave is five paid working days for a close family member; additional support may be approved. Jury service, neonatal care, parental bereavement and other protected leave go to People Operations without assuming these examples exhaust legal rights.

6. Records, worked example and controls

People Operations maintains balances and restricted absence records; managers see dates and operational cover needs, not detailed medical notes. See AQ-CMP-003 section 5 for retention. Example: a full-time employee with four ordinary days unused may carry four with approval, using them by 31 March

An employee returning from long-term sickness must be referred for a protected carry-forward assessment, even if their unused balance exceeds five. Quarterly checks reconcile payroll, leave balances and manager approvals. Version 2.1 clarifies protected carry-forward exceptions; no earlier version is included in this pack.